



Creative Brief for Website & Digital Marketing

Prepared August 2026 |

Objective

Close JCE's above-the-fold visibility gap so the site converts on the strong search position it already has for removal and pruning terms in its priority geography — recovering the 10–15 qualified leads/week lost to competitors, and resulting in 6–8 more booked jobs/week.

This is not a trust problem, and it's not really an organic SEO problem. JCE ranks well organically and already has the reputation and repeat business (80%+) to win once seen. The gap is that Local Service Ads, paid search, and AI Overviews now sit above organic listings on the results page, and JCE has never had a paid presence to compete for that space. A strong organic ranking no longer guarantees visibility.

Consumer Target

Who: Homeowners 45+ with established properties and mature trees, across River Falls (defend), Hudson & Prescott (build). Not price-sensitive shoppers or out-of-area inquiries.

Need-state priority: Planned work first — removal (especially large-tree and ash-specific jobs) ranks above pruning/trimming. This is the segment where homeowners compare a few estimates before deciding, which is exactly where JCE's proof can win.

What makes them different? They've already decided the work needs doing. The open question isn't whether to act, it's who to trust with their yard, which makes this a comparison-shopping audience, not an awareness one.

Insight

Homeowners comparing tree services can't actually tell who's good from the outside. Every competitor's site says "professional," "certified," and "we protect your property" — the claims have converged to the point where they're no longer differentiating. But before a homeowner even gets to comparing messaging, they have to see JCE at all. Google's results page has

changed: Local Service Ads, paid search, and AI Overviews now occupy the space above organic listings, so even a strong organic rank doesn't put JCE above the fold. JCE has never invested in the placements that now determine who gets seen first.

Key Benefit

No gambling on who shows up, or what your yard looks like when they're done.

Reasons to Believe

- 25 years of local experience in River Falls, celebrated in 2026
- Four ISA-certified arborists, two team members with forestry degrees, four licensed pesticide applicators
- 80%+ repeat-customer rate — proof the job is done right the first time
- Every estimate is a personal property visit, hand-written by an arborist (usually Joe himself), walked through in person or by phone
- A full range of equipment, each piece chosen specifically to protect the lawn and property

Guardrail

Treat River Falls and Hudson/Prescott differently. River Falls: protect the URL structure and organic rank already earned through the re-theme (any URL changes need a redirect plan, since we want to defend our organic ranking), and prioritize closing the paid/LSA gap above it (this is a visibility problem more than a rebuild). Hudson & Prescott: earn rank and build a site presence. Everywhere: the site itself should look and feel as current as JCE's actual standing in the market, since several competitors are visibly ahead on site quality regardless of ranking. And given the claims-convergence problem named above, every claim on the site should be backed by something a competitor can't say on command (a named review, a specific before/after, a real street or property reference.)

Tone & Manner

- Expert, not stuffy — explain clearly, never talk over a homeowner's head
- Warm, with a little humor on planned/everyday content
- Calm, direct, and reassuring specifically on emergency content
- Personal and local — name River Falls, Hudson, and Prescott specifically rather than "our service area"

Scope & functionality

- Core features, prioritized
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- User flows or key journeys through the product
- Any existing systems it needs to integrate with?

Design Direction

- Sites I like
- Service pages led by removal, pruning/trimming second
- Photo-led before/after content
- Reviews surfaced with specifics, not star ratings alone
- Estimate/contact CTA pages, plus "what happens after you reach out" content that sets up the personal-estimate visit as the next proof point

Content Direction

Deliverables

- A re-themed Wordpress website (with LocalBusiness, Service, and Review schema implemented site-wide) for all existing pages
- NEW SEO-structured location pages for River Falls, Prescott (I believe he has one for Hudson)
- Landing pages built to convert paid/LSA traffic specifically, since that's the new visitor source this brief is solving for
- A blog where we can add seasonal content (ex winter/frozen-ground trimming, fall oak and ash pruning) tied to when those searches actually spike

Timeline:

Week of August 24th: Brief Patrick + deliver content

Week of August 31: Design & Development

Week of Sept 7: Dev + QA

Week of Sept 14: Launch

APPROVED CONTENT

Homepage — approved by Joe

Job of this page: establish JCE as the visibly credentialed, locally-proven choice within the first 3 seconds.

- **Headline: The Highest Standard of Tree Care. No Exceptions.**
- **Subhead:** Trusted in River Falls, Prescott, Hudson and the St Croix River Valley for 25 years
- **Primary CTA:** "Get Your Personal Estimate" → </estimate/>
- **Secondary:** click-to-call phone number, always visible
- **Hero image:** JCE crew on a property.

Trust bar (directly under hero, horizontal strip) 4.9★ Rating · Locally Owned and Operated for 25 Years · 4 ISA-Certified Arborists · HomeAdvisor Elite Service

Anyone with a chainsaw can call themselves a tree service. Not everyone shows up with certified arborists, a fleet of equipment chosen to protect your lawn, and a professional, experienced crew that cleans up like they're leaving their own yard. That's the difference with JCE. For 25 years, we've earned the trust of local homeowners by doing the job right, from start to finish.

Section: Services

Tree Removal → Tree Pruning → Emergency Tree Service → Plant Health Care → Tree Inspection → Lot & Land Clearing → Brush Clean Up / Mowing → Stump Grinding.
Each tile: icon or photo, one-line description, link to service page.

Section: The Personal Estimate

1) You call, we schedule your free estimate.

A local arborist walks your property and figures out what's going on. Sometimes that means the tree comes down. Sometimes it means we tell you it didn't need to. Either way, you get an expert assessment and a clear recommendation on next steps.

2) We walk you through what's needed

You get a hand-written estimate on the spot, and we walk you through it. No callback in three days, no fine print to decode. Just a straight answer while we're standing right there looking at the same tree you are.

3) We schedule the job to fit your needs and the season.

Once you give the go-ahead, we get you on the schedule, timed to the job and the season. A dead ash in July and a leaning oak in January don't call for the same approach, and we'll tell you why.

Section: Credentials

What working with JCE's crew gets you

Local Tree Care Experts

Four ISA Certified Arborists and two forestry-degreed tree professionals on staff mean the person assessing your tree has the training to understand how trees grow, decline, and fail, and can tell you when removal is necessary and when a tree can be saved. It also means the crews working on your property bring deep knowledge of the trees, diseases, and conditions common to our area.

Locally owned and operated for 25 years

That means the owner lives in the same community you do, and you can reach him after the job just as easily as before it. Many of our employees have been with us for many years, and every crew member receives ongoing training to ensure consistently high-quality work.

4.9-star rating across the St. Croix River Valley

That means your neighbors have already put our work to the test on their own properties. We don't filter reviews, and the majority of our business comes from our referrals and repeat customers. We take great pride in our work, and you can expect us to bring that same level of care to your property.

Section: Credentials (Trusted & Credentialed pillar) Not a bare list. Pair each credential with "which means...": e.g., *"Four ISA-certified arborists on staff — which means the person diagnosing your tree's health has the training to be right about it."* Photo of the team, ideally on-site not posed studio shots.

Section: Service Area Map or list treatment: River Falls, Hudson, Prescott (primary), secondary towns (Ellsworth, Beldenville, Roberts, Houlton, Hammond, Baldwin, New Richmond, Spring Valley, Hastings, Afton, Lake St. Croix Beach, Lakeland). Links to the three location pages.

Closing CTA band: repeat phone + estimate CTA.

Section: Reviews 2–3 reviews surfaced with specifics (the actual street, the actual job, the actual outcome), not just star ratings.